

IG Entity Verification

In an IG Entity Verification task, you review another annotator's entity tag. You're shown a target image with a yellow box around the entity in question, and a reference image they picked for it. Your job is to decide whether those two actually refer to the same entity — and to call out broken inputs when the question can't be answered as posed.

The minimums

- **Read the entity type and label first** — they define what kind of match counts.
- **Pick 1–3 identifying features** the entity type hinges on (face structure, logo placement, signage, etc.) and check those.
- **Write a short reason** naming the features you used.

What you'll see

Two images side by side:

- **Left (Target)** — a photo with a yellow box drawn around a specific region. The entity inside that box is what's being verified.
- **Right (Reference)** — a photo the original annotator picked as a reference for that entity. If they picked a sub-region, it's outlined in green; otherwise the whole image is the reference.

Above the images you'll see the **entity type** (person, clothing, product, location, animal, information, or style) and a short **label** describing what was tagged.

Method

1. Read the entity type and label.
2. Look at the yellow box first — that's the only thing being verified on the target side.
3. Look at the green box on the reference (or the whole image if there's no green box).
4. Find 1–3 identifying features that should match for that entity type.
5. Pick a verdict based on whether those features actually match.
6. Write a short reason naming the features you used.

The verdict scale

You have four verdicts plus skip and flag. The key axis is **confidence**, not match strength.

- **Definitely same / definitely different** — the identifying feature is clearly visible in both images and clearly (mis)matches.
- **Likely same / likely different** — the answer is probably right, but image quality, angle, occlusion, or distance leaves room for doubt.
- **Skip** — you'd genuinely call it a coin flip. Don't use "likely" for this.

Identifying features by entity type

- **Person** — face structure, hairline, distinguishing marks. Hair color and clothing are not identity.
- **Clothing** — logo placement, strap width, cut, hardware. Color and style alone are *not* enough.
- **Product** — exact product variant (size, scent, flavor), not just brand or product line.
- **Location** — signage, distinctive architecture, fixed landmarks. Not "same kind of place."
- **Animal** — for a specific animal, individual markings (chest patch, eye color). Breed match is not identity match.

Worked examples

Animal — wrong call (breed ≠ identity)

Target (top) and reference (bottom)



Good

| **Likely different — markings don't match.** Both are brown tabbies, but the target cat has a solid white chest patch and a darker face mask; the reference has narrower face stripes and no white chest. Same breed, different individual.



Bad

| **Likely same — both are brown tabby cats.** Breed match is not identity match. This is the most common mistake on animal tasks — the reviewer locks onto the breed/coloring and skips the individual markings that actually verify identity.

When the entity type is *animal* and the label refers to a specific cat, identifying features mean individual markings, not breed. Two cats can both be brown tabbies and still be obviously different animals — chest markings, face stripe patterns, and eye shape are what carry identity.

Product — wrong call (same line ≠ same product)



Target (left) and reference (right) — same brand line, different products

Good

| **Definitely different — lip balm vs. sunscreen.** Target reads "Lip Balm — SPF 25, Shea Butter." Reference reads "SPF 25 Sunscreen — Natural Mint & Shea Butter." Same brand and shared ingredients, but lip balm and sunscreen are different products.

Bad

| **Definitely same — both are SPF 25 Shea Butter.** The label text overlaps, so it looks like a match at a glance. But "Lip Balm" and "Sunscreen" are different products in the same line — verifying products means matching the SKU, not the family.

When the entity type is *product*, the identifying feature is the exact product, not the brand or product family. Shared packaging cues like "SPF 25" and "Shea Butter" can pull your eye toward a match even when the items are entirely different SKUs.

Person — a real "likely same"



Target (left) and reference (right)

Good

| **Likely same — face structure matches but conditions limit certainty.** Jawline, nose shape, and lip shape align. Can't confirm eye color or full face geometry because target's eyes are closed and one side is partly occluded.

Bad

| **Definitely same — same face.** Confidence isn't justified here. The target's eyes are closed and her hand obscures part of the face — that's exactly the "quality, angle, or occlusion leaves doubt" case the *likely* tier exists for.

This is the textbook case for *likely* over *definitely*. Face structure, brow shape, and lip shape line up well across both images — it almost certainly is the same person — but the target has her eyes closed and partially occluded by her hand, so you can't pin down a clear feature match the way you could with both faces fully visible.

Skip vs. flag as bad data

You have two ways to pass on an item — they mean different things, and using the wrong one wastes annotator time.

Skip — *you can't tell, this one time*

Use when the images load fine and the source annotation looks legitimate, but you personally can't make a confident call. Example: the face is too distant or occluded, or you're not sure which side of *likely same* vs. *likely different* it falls on. The item goes back into the queue for someone else.

Flag as bad data — the source itself is broken

Use when the input shouldn't be verified by anyone. Examples:

- Either image fails to load or is heavily corrupted.
- The yellow box doesn't actually contain the claimed entity type (e.g., type says *clothing* but the box is around empty wall).
- The reference image is unrelated content — clearly not the claimed entity.
- The label or entity type is obviously wrong for what's shown.
- **The target and the reference are the same image.** A photo can't verify itself — there's nothing meaningful to compare. This is a broken input, not a *definitely same*. Flag it.

Don't flag because it's hard

Flags accumulate across annotators — once enough people flag the same item, it's automatically pulled from the queue. Flag only when you'd want every annotator who sees it to drop it too. "I can't tell" is a skip.